

Lesson 1: Introduction to the Melodion

◆ What is a Melodion?

- A free-reed wind instrument with a piano-style keyboard.
- Commonly used in music education, reggae, jazz, and folk.

◆ Parts of the Instrument:

- **Mouthpiece:** Where you blow air.
 - **Keyboard:** Usually 2 to 3 octaves.
 - **Air Chamber:** Produces sound when keys are pressed.
 - **Strap/Handle:** For holding during play.
-

Lesson 2: Holding & Blowing Techniques

🎯 Posture:

- Sit or stand comfortably.
- Hold the melodion in your left hand (if using a mouthpiece) or lay it flat and use the air tube.

💨 Breathing:

- Blow gently; no need to force air.
 - Constant, even airflow is key to good tone.
-

Lesson 3: Understanding the Keyboard

🎹 Notes:

- White keys: Natural notes (A–G)
- Black keys: Sharps and flats (e.g., C# / Db)

🎵 Practice:

1. Find **Middle C**.
2. Play the C major scale:
C - D - E - F - G - A - B - C

Practice slowly, then build speed.

Lesson 4: First Songs

🎵 Try "Twinkle Twinkle Little Star":

C C G G A A G – F F E E D D C

Then try:

- "Mary Had a Little Lamb"
 - "Happy Birthday"
 - "Ode to Joy"
-

Lesson 5: Playing with Both Hands (Advanced)

Most melodions are played with **one hand (right)** while holding the instrument with the left. If yours allows for two-hand play:

- Left hand: simple bass notes (C, G, F).
- Right hand: melody.